

Inherited Traits & Learned Behaviors

Use the cue, then fade the cue. Study the cue card for 60 seconds. Then cover it before answering Round 1. Check the card only after you commit to an answer.

CUE FOCUS **Inherited traits** come from parents, such as eye color, fur color, a flower's color, or floppy ears. **Learned behaviors** come from experience or practice, such as a dog doing a trick, a child riding a bike, or a bird taught a new song.

Round 1 — Retrieve It

1. Where do inherited traits come from?

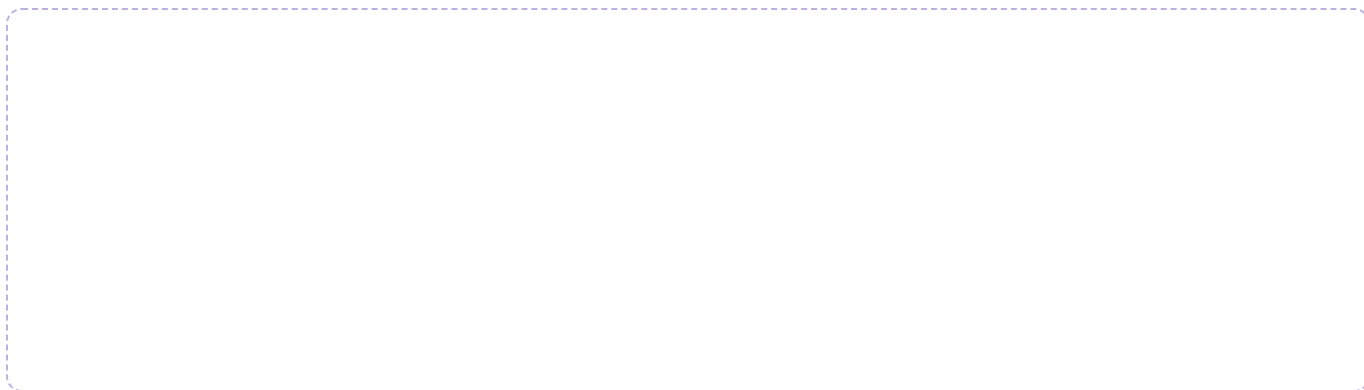
2. Where do learned behaviors come from?

3. Name one example of an inherited trait.

4. Name one example of a learned behavior.

Round 2 — Sketch It

Draw a T-chart. On one side draw and label an inherited trait. On the other side draw and label a learned behavior.



Inherited Traits & Learned Behaviors — Apply It

Keep the cue card covered. Answer first. Then use the cue to check, revise, and explain what you changed.

Round 3 — Apply the Idea

1. A puppy has floppy ears just like its mother. Is this an inherited trait or a learned behavior? How do you know?

2. A dog rolls over when its owner gives a command. Is this an inherited trait or a learned behavior? How do you know?

3. A sunflower is yellow like the plant it grew from. Is this inherited or learned? Explain.

Round 4 — Reason from Evidence

A student says, “Anything an animal is good at must have come from its parents.” Use an example of a learned behavior to explain why this is not always true.

Inherited Traits & Learned Behaviors — ACE It

Use the cue card only if you need it. The goal is to show what you can explain, connect, and use on your own.

A**Articulate**

Explain the difference between an inherited trait and a learned behavior. Give one example of each.

C**Connect**

Think about yourself. Name one inherited trait you have and one behavior you learned. Tell where each came from.

E**Extend**

A bird learns a new song from the birds around it. Explain how a young bird could have both an inherited trait and a learned behavior at the same time.

Confidence check. Circle one after you finish: I still need the cue / I need it once in a while / I can explain this without it.

Teacher Key — Inherited Traits & Learned Behaviors

Remove this page before student copying. Answers below give expected ideas, not required wording.

Retrieve It

1. From parents (passed down from the parents to their offspring).
2. From experience or practice (learned by doing or by being taught).
3. Any: eye color, fur or hair color, a flower's color, floppy ears, height.
4. Any: a dog doing a trick, riding a bike, a bird taught a song, reading, tying shoes.

Sketch It — look for

A clear T-chart: one side shows a labeled inherited trait (from parents), the other shows a labeled learned behavior (from experience).

Apply It

1. Inherited trait; floppy ears were passed down from the parent, not learned.
2. Learned behavior; the dog was taught and practiced the command.
3. Inherited; the flower's color was passed down from the plant it grew from.

Reason from Evidence — look for

Not everything comes from parents. Skills like riding a bike or a dog's trick are learned through practice or teaching, so being good at something can come from experience, not inheritance.

ACE — Extend look-for

Student sees the bird can inherit traits (such as feather color or the ability to sing) while the exact song it sings is learned from other birds around it.

Suggested use. Run Page 1 with the cue card available, Page 2 with the cue mostly covered, and Page 3 as independent reflection. Let students uncover the cue to self-correct in a different color.